Principles of the
course of actions taken
towards the aboriginal Formosa.
(No 3)

On the 13th of the eight
monsh, our Minister Yanaghi-
wara received an official despa-
tch and a note from the
Tsung-li-yamen, the chief
purport of which is as follows:

"It is very clear from
the evidence set forth in the
Taiwanfoteje, that the several
communities in Formosa have
belonged to China. Now you
confessed clearly in your former
despatch, that the whole island
of Formosa has belonged since
long to China, while you ave-
red in your later despatch, that

the aboriginals of Formosa have been
always independent and masterless
savages. This is a quite strange
contradiction. As to a little in-
consistency observed in the words
of the treasurer Pan-ui, there is
a reason for it, because what
he said in his reply to you at
Shanghai was founded upon the
conference with you, while what
he said after his arriving at Fo-
kien was based on his discussion
with the general Saigo. Moreover,
the meaning of your dispatch to
Shin and Pan is quite incon-
sistent with your confession of the
desire to preserve the mutual
friendly relation."

Now as the treasurer Pan-
ui was strongly objected by Ya-
nagihiwara, on account of his
contradic

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contradictory words, he was unable to return any answer. For this the Chinese officials devising a trick to find out some weak points in Nanaghiwara's despatch and to draw a very wrong and forced inference from them was only enabled to send the above mentioned despatch and note.

This was an evily device left to the Chinese officials.

On the same day the Chinese high officer Son and six others visited the Minister Nagahiwara to return his late visit to them and held a conference with the Minister, the secretary Sei, Yanabe Saitchi, an officer of gaimusho of the fourth rank and Yukushima Kunari the Japanese consul at Amoy, the chief

points of which on the side of the Chinese officials are as follows:

"It is to be seen clearly from Daiwanfoolooje, that the aboriginals have been under the jurisdiction of China.

Now, this book is an old and impartial one, not specially compiled for the present use. This being case, it is a good authority to be observed by all the nations of the present time and your country is no exception to it. And your shipwrecked countrymen from Botchin did not lose their lives at Penan but were preserved from the injury by the kindness of Jinngan-sei. Moreover, there is an express provision in the first article of the treaty and the ambassador Soyeshima's avowal bearing upon

upon the matter, still your govern-
ment have not recognized our ju-
risdiction over the aboriginals and
sent an expeditionary corps again-
st them. The injustice of the ac-
tions of your government is quite
evident from the authority of Tai-
wan-tze. But there shall be no
term for the discussions and de-
bates and we hope to settle the
present subject speedily by the
mutual agreement. We only desire
you to wait for our decision, to
get a definite answer on the
subject of the so called obligation
of your government and the other
matter relating to it.

To these words our officers
returned an answer which follows:

"When we inquired to our
shipwrecked countrymen of Bitchiu

about the circumstances of their
disaster, in gaimusho, they declared
us, that when they were driven to the
shores of Penan, they were not only
surrounded by the savages and all
their shipstores and clothes were pil-
laged by them, but they were also
threatened with immediate death, from
which they were enabled to escape
solely by the intercession of some one,
and that after his narrow escape
they sought the aid of Sin-ngan-sai
from this, it must be concluded that
the savages should have murdered
them after committing the crime of
pillage, if there were no intercessors."

"When our national troops first
arrived at Liang-kian and desir-
ing to rest a campground from
the natives inquired them, if the
lands were their own or not, they

answered

answered in the affirmative, adding that the lands have been cultivated by themselves, not subject to any one else, though a portion of them pays some tribute to the savage tribes. This is a very clear evidence of these lands not being subject to China. Besides, Kong Kong lies far from our camp; nevertheless, several chiefs of his community presented themselves to our camp, begging the extermination of the cruel savages, who have pitilessly injured them and offering at the same time their services and military stores. Thus, the native tribes came, uninvited, to our camp to entreat joyfully our protection. Since forty years, there has been no arbiter among the native tribes to judge their continual disputes and to prevent

their quarrels, after ending in bloodshed. But now, they were enabled to sue for the arbitration to the general Saigo. If you claim your jurisdiction over these tribes, why did you overlooked such an important matter as the fight and bloodshed? You pretend also to rely yourselves on the authority of the Taiwanfoologe written in your country. Well, in a book compiled in our country, there is an evidence that above three hundred years ago our countrymen migrated thither. What belief do you attach to it? Besides, there is a book, recently written by an Englishman, confirming that the savage tribes have been always independent tribes."

As to the provisions of the treaty, there is no dispute, that we must always abide by them. But to address

those

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these provisions as an evidence bearing on the present matter, is quite unreasonable. Suppose, that our troops should have invaded Taiwanfoo or Amoy, then your government would be indeed reasonable. But, it is quite another thing to invade the territory of the savage tribes."

"We hope, consequently, that you will disregard all such minute details and consider only the principal points concerning the present matter. Our government punished the savage tribes solely by their obligation and they have nothing else to pretend. We could not believe your claims, that the aboriginal territory has been subject to China. What should be the next measures to be taken by your government. We beg to visit your Yamen on the 17th

and to be informed of these measures."

On the 15th day of August Yanaghiwara has sent the two letters in reply to Tsung-li-yamen of which the following is the summary.

"You have found he errors of more words and phrases in my recent letters and pronounced my verbal communications to be inconsistant with each other. I cannot admit this."

"It has always been the subjects of my letters and conversations, after my arrival at Shanghai, to say that the land of the aboriginal tribes does not belong to your country. This will be evident if you will inspect my two recent communications and the first draughts of Pan's communication and if you will inspect the note of the conversation between Pan and Saigo those mistakes and absurdities

absurdities will be at once evident.

"If the land of the aboriginal tribes does belong to your country, why did you not offer a strong objection last year when we made a special notice of our attempted expedition? After our country had appointed a general for the punishment of the savages and they have submitted to our government, you begin to disapprove our course of action; is it not too late, for a general having received his imperial instruction, a grand army under his command could not return without having accomplished any thing. Please tell me what you should do with the army in a similar case and I shall be very glad to send back our army to our country."

One other day I have had an interview with you and accepted your

request of my answer. I, therefore, now send my answer trusting you will settle the question, collecting and considering the arguments."

On the 17th day of August at Young-li-yamen, Minister Yanagihara has had an interview with Prince Kun and others, when Chinese officers said "the consequence of the expedition entertained and to seek our own good may be a state of war or a state of peace but as both countries use the same written language and are contiguous to each other, as the teeth to the lips, we should maintain the peace between us, following in this the proverb which says. Brothers who are quarreling with each other, should make the common cause against the common enemy; and having known you long enough, I will speak without

without concealment. The more the number of letters forwarded and conferences held the more the number of secondary propositions arising out of them and no good result follow.

The best way is, I think, to follow the principles of good faith and reciprocity, and to be afraid of the bad opinion of us by the foreign countries; and let us say that suppose one of us, in case war begun, should have success, and neither of us will gain nothing. If we know this truth clearly, no argument is necessary to be made.

"In our present case our country must give your country some good result and in return your country, our country some one: this is what we call the principles of good faith and reciprocity.

"As to the righteousness of the expedition against the savages

your country might easily decide in favour of it, but in our country we have many colleagues and other ministers to consult with and could not answer very soon."

Yamaguchiwara said in reply "our country does not like making war; but I mean that we are sending one letter after another and holding one conference after another only to make the disagreement of opinions between us greater, and that we cannot submit to your opinion against our will, because we are performing obligation of our country of course I do not disagree to your proposition that we must abandon argument and take our own wise measures; but I wish that the steps toward the conclusion should be taken very soon, because the

the matter before us is very im-
portant and besides of late I had
a messenger from our government
who brought an instruction to me
Longer delay are sure to bring
more current reports home and ab-
road, against us; so I wish that
if you do not decide the matter to
day, you will sent a decisive ans-
wer within a few days."

On the August 22nd Toun-
li-Jai-sim (Foreign Minister) sent
two letters to the minister Yanaghi
Wara, the extracts of which are as
follows:

That the territories of the abo-
riginal Formosans belong to China;
China governes over them; the
benefits have extended to the fo-
reign countries; although there were
the cases that the shipwrecked fo-

reigners were illtreated and killed,
China expects always to settle the
cases, preparing the regular rules;
if your forces shall draw back
from the island, China can be
able to arrange for future, and much
more understand throughly the mean-
ing proposed by your government,
that it is important to real up the
people.

But, while China hold the
territories of the aboriginal Formosans
to be out of the jurisdiction and
look on the sufferings of every
foreigners with disregards, they pro-
claim that the benefits have extend-
ed to the foreign countries! Whether
they do expect the sufferings of
Foreigners to be their benefits, or
Whether they do gloss over their fa-
ults with such a fiction.

On

On the 24th same month, Yanaghiwara gave the reply to the above letters, extract of which is as follows:

If the opinion of your government is so as mentioned in your letters, the further repeated discussions should be endless; Now it is laid down to you in particular, that our country have punished isolated barbarous tribes, this is the right of a independent state, and needs no objection from other countries; Then, our government will take in mind the general right of extending the benevolence so will outside as inside, and mollify gradually the aboriginal tribes and bring them under our good influence; this is evidenally the point at which our government desideedly has acted to reach.

Having made the above reply, Yanaghiwara waited upon a decided and critical reply from the Chinese high officer.

On the 26th the same month, the principal meaning contained in the letter from Tsun-li-Yai-sim, is as follows:

"The aboriginal Formosans belong to our Taiwan and form a part of Chinese empire and ought not to be called isolated barbarous tribes; as to mollifying and bringing them under good influence, our own country has the right of self-governing without the objection."

Now, it has became clear that the opinion of China differs greatly from that of our own government

vernment.

Before this time, China has collected great forces and sent them towards southern provinces, as the reinforcement to the troops at Taiwan, and summoned together all the veterans to Peking who had engaged in the war of the former years.

Yanagihiwara, hearing the arrival at Yientsin of Ben-ri-Jaisin Okubo, sent his men there to invite him and prepared to consult together the plan of further discussion with China. And Kaigun-Tai-i Yashida was sent back to Japan in order to report to the government the following:

The discussions between two countries are at the very point

of deciding and China is very busy in preparing defence middled and then it is necessary to order our forces for immediate movement at the time.

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